

SAFE WORK METHOD STATEMENT

Persons responsible for supervising, inspecting work, work methods, plant & equipment and tools	Supervisor/Foreman:	Date:	
High Risk Construction Work:	Construction of an Underground Water Main in a Road Reserve – Traffic Management & Movement of Mobile Plant (VT, EXC & HDD)	Project:	
SWMS prepared by Patrick Monaghan - Paneltec Group - Operations Manager and in consultation with management and workers – 2025. SWMS Review Date: August 2026 unless required earlier		Location:	
Approval to use this SWMS: "I certify that the attached SWMS has been reviewed by me, is endorsed for compliance with WorkSafe guidelines and is approved for use."			
John Guy	Director - Paneltec Pty Ltd	0408 449 023	31/08/2026 - V12.0
Name	Position	Signature	Date

RISK MATRIX

Level	Description of Consequence or Impact	Consequence	Likelihood / Probability		
			L Likely	M Moderate	U Unlikely
H (1) (High level of harm)	Potential death, permanent disability or major structural failure/damage. Off-site environmental discharge/release not contained and significant long-term environmental harm.	H (1) (High)	1	1	2
M (2) (Medium level of harm)	Potential temporary disability or minor structural failure/damage. On-site environmental discharge/release contained, minor remediation required, short-term environmental harm.	M (2) (Medium)	1	2	3
L (3) (Low level of harm)	Incident that has the potential to cause persons to require first aid. On-site environmental discharge/release immediately contained, minor level clean up with no short-term environmental harm.	L (3) (Low)	2	3	3
Level	Likelihood / Probability				
Likely	Could happen frequently				
Moderate	Could happen occasionally				
Unlikely	May occur only in exceptional circumstances				

HIERARCHY OF RISK CONTROL

The hierarchy of controls must be applied in the order below for all identified hazards.

Level 1 Eliminate the hazard
Level 2 Substitute the hazard with something safer.
Level 3 Isolate the hazard from people. Reduce the risks through engineering controls.
Level 4 Reduce exposure to the hazard using administrative actions.
Level 5 Use personal protective equipment
The control measures that you put in place should be reviewed regularly to make sure they work as planned

ACTIVITY ANALYSIS

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Residual Risk
1.0 General Safety Requirements 	Personal injury to operator and other workers.	1	- All persons and subcontractors working on site need a current TasWater Induction Card and a Const. Industry White Card (or equivalent) - Compliance with these SWMS may be monitored via audit regimes throughout the duration of the project by Paneltec's Compliance Manager or TasWater Representative(s) - All persons who are to operate or assist with the operation of the Vacuum Truck are to be fully competent with either; <i>Operate a Drain Cleaning System</i> and <i>Vacuum Loading Certificate</i> or <i>Type 'A' Water Jetting Certificate</i> and have received information and instruction in the safe use of the machine and the potential hazards. - All Excavator operators operating plant must be trained and competent. - All Traffic Controllers on site must be accredited in: <i>RIIWH5205D Control Traffic with a Stop Slow Bat</i> <i>RIIWH5302D Implement traffic management plan.</i> In accordance with the <i>Department of State Growth</i> Guideline – <i>Traffic Control for Work on Roads 2020</i> - Complete Site-Specific Risk Assessment (SSRA) prior to commencing works (Identify all Site-Specific Safety Requirements) - Conduct Tailgate Meeting during completion of SSRA discuss any pertinent site-specific hazards and lessons learnt (E.g., Asset Locations, Weather, No Go Areas etc.) - Complete and sign all relevant permits (Paneltec Excavation, Hot Work etc.) - All NDD operators must be familiar with the operator's instruction manual before using the plant. - Know how to stop and start the vacuum and bleed pressure quickly. - Be familiar with controls. - Monitor NDD tank levels and weather conditions. - Do not work in an electrical storm. - The vacuum is to be operated only by trained, competent staff. - The HDD and associated equipment are to be operated by competent, experienced staff. - All asset locations are to be undertaken by a DBYD accredited locator.	All Compliance Manager TasWater Operators Traffic Controllers All All Supervisor All NDD Operators HDD Operators DBYD Locator	2

			17. All workers are to wear required PPE in accordance with TasWater & Paneltec's PIPE Policy: • Highly Visible Workwear – Long Pants & Shirt (Sleeves Down) • Safety Boots • Hard Hat – No caps underneath • Safety Glasses - AS/NZS1337 • Hearing Protection (Where Required) • Gloves and Glove Clip • Face Shield in addition to Safety Glasses or goggle and mask combination when cutting, grinding, using compressed air or <u>high-pressure water jetting</u>	Supervisor All	
2.0 Setting Out or taking down Roadwork Signage for Traffic Control and setting out work area 	Persons being struck by oncoming traffic or construction plant	1	1. Traffic Controllers to verify that the correct signage, control devices Traffic Management Plan (TMP) and Traffic Guidance Scheme (TGS) are onsite and ready for implementation. 2. Verify all Traffic Controllers have PPE in accordance with 1.16 above. 3. Traffic Controller to adopt whichever control measure(s) is applicable to the site/situation as per TGS and or TMP: • Establish/Verify the clear escape route for all traffic controllers. • All control measures, traffic control devices and signage as per the TGS • Sequence of setup to be in accordance with TGS installation sequence. 4. If additional guidance to the TMP is required - refer to the Department of State Growth (DSG) <i>Traffic Control for Work on Roads-2020 Guidance Notes</i> and <i>Austroads Guides to Temporary Traffic Management (AGTTM)</i> and AS1742.3 5. If changes to the TGS are required due to operational conditions, changes may be made by a senior traffic controller providing they are documented. 6. Due diligence must be applied when setting up traffic control as personnel are working unprotected, except for the traffic vehicle with flashing arrow board and flashing lights on. 7. Refer to the TMP and TGS for all additional site-specific set up procedures. 8. Barricade the work area, to prevent inadvertent access by public. 9. Ensure all pedestrians and cyclists have safe passage around the work site. 10. Traffic control set out vehicles to display flashing amber lights & flashing arrow board. Reverse beepers and vehicle horn must all be functional. Safety signage and traffic control devices will conform with the <i>DOS- Traffic</i>	Traffic Controllers Supervisor Traffic Controllers Traffic Controllers Traffic Controllers	2

			Control for Work on Roads-2023 guidance notes, AGTTM and AS1742.3 to ensure safety and minimise inconvenience to traffic.	Traffic Controllers	
3.0 Underground Asset Locating	Injuries or accidents occurring to employees/public and contact/damage with underground infrastructure	1	1. All persons engaged in the locating works are to be trained and competent in <i>RIICCM202D Identify, locate and protect underground services</i>. 2. Locator to be an accredited Dial Before You Dig Certified Locator and Telstra Accredited Locator. Paneltec is a CLO with DBYD. 3. Locator to ensure all DBYD enquiry sequence numbers are in the work pack prior to location and that the DBYD enquiry is within 28 Days of enquiry date. 4. Locator to locate all known underground infrastructure and remain vigilant for any signs of unknown or unrecorded infrastructure. 5. Refer to Paneltec SWP-30 Opening Manholes – Safe Handling when opening manholes. 6. All location works to be completed under the TGS when working within the road reserve (Refer 2.0 Above)	Supervisor Asset Locator	2
4.0 Electrical Hazards 	Electrocution	1	1. Ensure all underground electrical infrastructure has been located by consulting with the Paneltec Asset Locator 2. If underground or above ground electrical infrastructure cannot be located or defined, TasNetworks must be consulted prior to excavation. 3. Conduct a visual inspection for overhead electrical infrastructure: If the distance between the vehicle/boom/cassette or operating implement and the LV (Bottom Powerlines, Wooden Pole WP) will be less than 1.0m or 3.0m (Top 22KV Powerlines, WP) reposition all equipment or introduce the control measures outlined in our SSRA/JSEA. 4. Ensure a spotter is always in place when maneuvering vehicle/boom/cassette or operating implement around the overhead electrical safety envelope. 5. Ensure Paneltec's WHS 05: Emergency Procedures are available for reference in the event of an emergency.	Supervisor Supervisor Operator Operator Operator Plumber	2

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			5. Persons unloading the excavator to wear correctly adjusted seat belt.		
8.1 Mechanical Excavation – Pre-Starts & Preliminary Checks 	Unsafe working conditions. Potential for accident	1	6. Conduct Plant & Equipment Pre-start on WHS Monitor for the machine 7. Do not proceed with any work if Plant or Attachments are unsafe or not fit for purpose. 8. Check with the Project Manager and Supervisor that all asset locations have been undertaken and review all DBYD's. 9. Complete Excavation Permit - All Sections (Paneltec and or TasWater) 10. Allocate the spotter for monitoring the movements of the excavator. 11. Ensure all controls are in neutral or park. 12. Ensure all gear in the cabin is correctly stored. 13. Adjust the seat and use the seat belt. 14. Warm up engine and hydraulic oil before starting work	Operator	2
8.2 Mechanical Excavation – Traveling equipment on roadway, private or public areas	Damage to roadway or public / private property	2	15. Check ownership of properties or boundaries. 16. Travel machine as to avoid disturbance to roadway or public or private lands e.g., lift machine to turn on undisturbed areas if required, avoid sharp turns on roadways. 17. Be aware of what damage the tracks can do to surfaces.	Operator	3
8.3 Mechanical Excavation - Clearing & grubbing Excavation placement and compaction fill.	Striking other objects whilst slewing excavator, materials on the ground flicking up as excavator travels over site. Overbalance of machine at reach.	1	18. Prior to excavation ensure the area is cordoned off from inadvertent access 19. If traffic controllers are on-site, they can assist with this set-up. 20. Be aware of what obstacles are around the site especially when slewing excavator. 21. If required, A spotter in place whilst machine is in operation in vicinity of underground / overhead services. 22. Assess what weights the machine can handle at reach safely before attempting to load trucks. 23. Do not carry passengers. 24. Always keep machine under control. 25.	Operator Traffic Controller	2
8.5 Mechanical Excavation – Excavation placement and compaction fill.	Striking underground assets or services	1	26. Ensure all above requirements have been facilitated prior to excavation with particular emphasis on sections 1, 3, 4 & 6. 27. Ensure the Paneltec Excavation Permit is signed by all civil workers on-site and the clearances stated on page 5 are adhered to at all times. 28. Carry the bucket as close to the ground as possible whilst traveling. 29. Travel & operate at a safe speed for the operation being undertaken. 30. Place spoil pile 1m from open excavation when trenching where possible		2

8.6 Mechanical Excavation - Deeper than (>)1.5m	Trench subsidence or collapse. Unsafe working conditions. Potential for accident	1	31. Inclusive of all requirements outlined in 8.5 above the below requirements shall be met when excavating deeper than 1.5m 32. Where the excavation is anticipated or is deeper than 1.5m review your excavation permit or complete a new one 33. Batter, Bench or Shore the Excavation in accordance with the requirements outlined in the Safe Work Australia – Excavation Code of Practice. 34. No person under any circumstances is to enter an excavation >1.5m depth without the excavation being benched battered or shored.	Operator Operator Supervisor	2
8.4 Mechanical Excavation – Rock Breaking Attachment	Rock breaker & pulverizer operation Flying fragments or reo steel from concrete	1	35. Be aware that rock fragments can fly from the chisel of the rock breaker, and pulverizer attachments, ensure the spotter has all PPE in accordance – 1.17. 36. Whilst operating the excavator be aware that demolition debris such as reo. and concrete can be flicked up by the tracks and could hit a worker or machine. Use double eye protection & Class 5 hearing protection & advise all others to keep well away from the work area when using this attachment	Operator	2
8.7 Packing up and Loading Excavator		1	37. Reverse all procedures in unloading the Excavator. 38. If contamination is evident on site (flora/soil) wash the plant down on site, prior to loading. 39. The traffic signs and traffic cones must stay in place until the plant is secured, and you are ready to depart site.	Traffic Controller Operator Supervisor	2
9.0 Horizontal Directional Drill (HDD) - Loading or Unloading HDD	Various injuries and or property damage.	1	1. Persons not involved in loading or unloading of plant/equipment to be kept clear of the area, in case the load falls or topples from the trailer or float. 2. Load and unload on stable, level ground, using the pendant control externally, persons are not permitted within cabin when loading/unloading drill. 3. Chock wheels transporter/tilt tray to prevent movement when required. 4. Make sure that portable loading ramps, tilt tray are reasonably clean, firm, secure, and in line with the deck. 5. Carefully line up the drill with the ramp and float, tilt tray. 6. Use low gear only when loading/unloading drills. 7. Position the drill so that its weight is evenly distributed on the float/tilt tray. 8. Avoid parking machines on slopes.	Supervisor Truck Driver Operator Operator	2

9.1 HDD - Cordon off site area from potential inadvertent access	Injuries to public, or other persons from collision with traffic or other plant.	1	9. Place traffic cones around the operational area in a 360-degree field around the drill 10. Place extendable tiger tailed sticks over traffic cones in areas where it is not safe for entry (excavation, near drill rack) 11. Re check all traffic signs are still in the appropriate place from unloading and 12. still in correct position for safe drill operation	Drill Operator	2
10.2 HDD - Entering the Drill	Various injuries to operator from using wrong entry techniques	1	13. Ensure 3 points of contact is made when entering the drill grasping the hand support rails fitted inside the cabin.	Drill Operator	2
10.3 HDD - Operating the Drill	Crush hazards, roll over, striking underground infrastructure	1	14. The operator of the drill must be appropriately competent and experienced in the operation of the drill that is being used. 15. All operations of the drill must be in accordance with the training received that is specific to that drill. 16. All pre-work documentation (HDD survey, JSEA/SSRA) and DBYD review must have been completed before the drill begins operation. 17. Before operating the drill, the operator must ensure that all emergency stops are operational internal and external.	Drill Operator	2
	Striking Underground Electrical Infrastructure	1	18. The drill is equipped with a strike alert should the drill head or rods make inadvertent access with underground power. 19. In the event the strike alarm does sound the operator must remain Seated within their cabin and avoid touching any metal components. 20. The operator must remain within the cabin until the power company arrives on site. 21. If necessary due to fire, the operator must kangaroo jump as far as possible away from the drill avoiding all water or metallic items.	Drill Operator	2
10.4 HDD - Exiting the Drill	Various injuries to operator from using wrong entry techniques	1	22. Ensure 3 points of contact is maintained when exiting the drill grasping the hand support rails fitted inside the cabin. 23. When exiting the cabin, it is recommended that the main cabin is pivoted away from the main drill rack as far as possible. NOTE: Where it is not possible to pivot the cabin away from the drill rack on entry extra precautions must be applied to avoid crushing injuries from drill rack (isolation etc.).	Drill Operator	2
10.5 HDD - Packing up the Drill and Loading the Drill		1	24. Reverse all procedures in unloading the drill. 25. If contamination is evident on site (flora/soil) wash the drill and plant down on site, prior to loading. 26. The traffic signs and traffic cones must stay in place until the drill is secured,	Truck Driver Drill Operator Supervisor	2

			and you are ready to depart site.		
10.6 HDD - Removal of Site Traffic Control Devices		1	On completion of the project all site signage is to be removed/decommissioned in the reverse order of its implementation.	Traffic Controllers	2

ENVIRONMENTAL RISK ASSESSMENT & CONTROL MEASURES THAT MAY BE REQUIRED ON SITE DEPENDING ON THE ACTIVITY					
Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Emergencies	Accident/ Incident Fire Spill	1	1. Personnel have been advised at tailgate meeting of designated emergency muster point and are prepared in the event of an incident occurring. 2. Emergency numbers are available in <i>WHS Monitor - WHS 05 Emergency Procedures</i>. 3. Fire Extinguishers/First Aid Kits/Spill Kits on site.	Supervisor All	2
Air Quality	Exhaust Fumes Dust	2	1. Control exhaust emissions e.g., Regular maintenance, replace old machinery, fit appropriate emission control measures.	Supervisor All	3
Community Relations	Inconvenience as a result of works/traffic management	2	1. TasWater to notify local residents in advance of works being undertaken. 2. All complaints to be reported to TasWater Customer Service Centre	Supervisor All	3
	Irate residents and complaints	2	1. All complaints to be reported to TasWater Customer Service Centre	Operators	3
Flora & Fauna	Some works may require removal of vegetation for truck access to TasWater Network.	2	1. Assess work area for significant vegetation: size of trees, faunal habitat defines work and exclusion areas using fencing and signage. 2. Approval to be sought from TasWater, prior to removal of any vegetation.	Supervisor All TasWater	3
	Transference of noxious weeds	3	1. Machinery is to be thoroughly washed down prior to leaving. site where noxious weeds are present.	Operators	3

Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Noise Pollution	Sensitivity to noise - to public & fauna	1	1. Work undertaken during “normal” hours where possible. 2. Notification of works to effected residents. 3. Plant and equipment regularly serviced & fitted with efficient mufflers.	Supervisor All	2
Soil Management & Water Quality	Mud deposited onto roadways.	2	1. Wash down machinery in only nominated areas. 2. Drivers to check vehicle tires/bodies for buildup of mud.	Supervisor All	3
Fuels and Chemicals	Contamination of waterways due to spillages of oil, degreasers, diesel, etc.	1	1. Store fuel and chemicals in accordance with relevant standards/guidelines. 2. Spill kits or alternative spill containment materials available on site. 1. Use correct refueling equipment.	Supervisor All	2
Visual Impact Litter and Amenities Waste Management	Litter such as paper, plastic, and other refuse on-site. Artificial lighting, litter, mud, dirt and dust may also impact residents.	2	1. Use site induction to communicate the requirement for a tidy site. Also stress consideration for local residents. 2. If as a result of our works, dirt, mud, or litter affects a resident, then we will rectify this problem immediately. 3. Inspect the site frequently and insist on tidiness. Ensure public roads are free of dirt/mud from the work site. 4. Remove all rubbish from site each day.	Supervisor All	3

List of plant for this Activity

Vacuum Truck, HDD

Personal Protective Equipment

All site personnel must wear the required PPE specified in the controls above, such as:

Safety Highly Visible Vests/Workwear	Safety Boots	Sunscreen	Sun ring for Hard Hat (UV)	Sunglasses (Approved Safety)	Razor Shield Gloves & Clip	White reflective overalls (Nightworks)
Hard Hat at all Times	Safety Glasses	Hearing protection where required	Long Sleeves and Pants	Dust masks	Respiratory Helmets if and when required	Face Shield when using jetting hose

Workers may require Task Specific Training depending on activity each worker will be required to fulfill.

All workers shall hold a current Construction Induction Card			
- TasWater Induction - Activity Induction (SWMS & SWP's) - Site specific requirements (external)	- TasWater Induction - Activity Induction (SWMS & SWP's) - Site specific requirements (external)	- TasWater Induction - Activity Induction (SWMS & SWP's) - Site specific requirements (external)	- TasWater Induction - Activity Induction (SWMS & SWP's) - Site specific requirements (external)
First Aid certificate training	First Aid certificate training	First Aid certificate training	First Aid certificate training

A Daily Tailgate Meeting will be held each day prior to the start of works.

Legislation & Codes of Practice (refer to company Legislation register for applicable Australian Standards applicable to works)

Work Health & Safety Act 2012 and Work Health & Safety Regulations 2022

Codes of Practice

Confined Spaces - 2020	Hazardous Manual Tasks - 2020	Managing Noise & Preventing Hearing Loss at Work-2020	Managing Risks of Plant in the Workplace - 2020
Construction Work - 2020	How to Manage WH&S Risks - 2018	Managing Risk of Falls at Workplaces - 2020	Managing Electrical Risks in the Workplace -2019
Excavation Work - 2020	First Aid in the Workplace - 2018	Managing Work Environment & Facilities - 2020	WHS Consultation Co-operation & Co-ordination - 2018
Welding Processes - 2021	How to Safely Remove Asbestos - 2020	Managing Risk of Hazardous Chemicals - 2018	Safe Design of Structures - 2018
Guide for Managing Risks from High Pressure water Jetting 2020			

Plant & Equipment for this activity

- All plant is inspected prior to sending out to site – HDD & Vacuum Truck
- Daily maintenance & service checks.
- Daily pre-start checks are conducted on all plant and trucks by the operators and daily checklist filled out.
- Regular servicing at 250hr intervals or as per manufactures specifications. Service History available on request to the office.

WORK ACTIVITY BRIEFING**Implementation, Monitoring and Review of SWMS**

The Supervisor on site has the responsibility to:

- Brief each team member on this SWMS before commencing work.
- Ensure control measures have been implemented prior to the start of works.
- Observe work being carried out.
- If controls documented in SWMS are not adequate, stop the work, review the SWMS, adjust as required and re-brief the team.
- Ensure team knows that work is to immediately stop if the SWMS is not being followed.
- Retain this SWMS on site for the duration of the high-risk construction work.
- All persons involved in these particular tasks on site must sign this document as read and understood.

SWMS attendance sheet — I have been given the opportunity to provide input into the development and review of this SWMS.

Name (please print clearly)	Signature	Company	Date

Daily pre-start meetings will be held to ensure all workers are informed of control measures and additional safety hazards & controls to be noted on toolbox form.